Assignment Brief: Dignity, Privacy, and Ethical Considerations in Care Settings

Course/Module: Meet personal support needs

Assessment Weight: 100 Marks (100% of Assignment Grade)

Format: ShortEssay/Critical Responses

Expected Length: 300–450 words per question (3,000–4,500 words total)

Instructions to Students

This assignment requires you to critically evaluate contemporary frameworks in institutional care, ethics, law, and quality improvement. While these themes may have been introduced in course webinars, **every response must be grounded in independent external research**.

You must cite external literature, legal statutes, sociological concepts, or comparative international frameworks as specified in each prompt. Ensure all sources are correctly cited using the required academic referencing style (e.g., APA 7th Edition).

Question 1:
What is the difference between "inherent dignity" and "attributed dignity" in an aged care setting, and how can a care worker practically demonstrate respect for a resident's dignity during routine care tasks?

Question 2:
Describe three specific operational practices care staff must follow when providing personal care (such as showering, dressing, or toileting) to safeguard a resident's physical privacy and emotional comfort in a residential facility.

Question 3:
Under privacy legislation and aged care standards, what are a care worker's legal obligations regarding a resident's personal health records, and under what specific circumstances is sharing confidential information legally or ethically required?

Question 4:

How should a care worker handle a situation where a competent resident exercises their legal right to refuse a recommended medication, meal, or personal hygiene routine? What steps must be taken to balance client autonomy with staff duty of care?

Question 5:
Explain the concept of "Dignity of Risk." How does a care worker support an older person's right to make choices that involve potential physical risk (such as walking unassisted or participating in activities) without neglecting their professional duty of care?

Question 6:
When an older person lacks cognitive capacity to make complex care decisions, who is legally authorized to make decisions on their behalf, and how must care staff ensure the individual's prior preferences and wishes are still honored?

Question 7:
Why is understanding a client's cultural background, religious beliefs, or LGBTQIA+ identity essential for ethical care, and how can care staff adapt their communication and support to ensure a culturally safe environment?

Question 8:
What are the strict legal and ethical conditions under which restrictive practices (chemical, physical, environmental, mechanical, or seclusion) may be used, and why are they categorized strictly as a last resort?

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Question 9:
Define "professional boundaries" in the context of aged and community care. What are two examples of boundary violations (such as accepting financial gifts or oversharing personal details) and how do they compromise ethical care?

Question 10:

What role does an independent advocate play when a resident feels their dignity or privacy has been compromised, and how should care staff assist a resident to access advocacy services without fear of retribution?

Marking Scheme & Grading Rubric (100 Marks Total)

Each of the 10 questions is worth **10 marks**,assessed against the following criteria:

High Distinction	9 - 10	Exceptional synthesis of external research. Argument is highly critical, nuanced, and perfectly directly addresses all parts of the prompt. Flawless referencing.
Distinction	7.5 - 8.5	Strong integration of external concepts. Solid analysis with clear logical flow. Minor gaps in depth or minor formatting issues.
Credit	6 - 7	Adequate research, though relies on basic definitions. Analysis is present but lacks critical depth or systemic insight. Competent writing and referencing.
Pass	5 - 5.5	Barely addresses the prompt. Heavy reliance on course materials rather than independent external research. Descriptive rather than analytical.
Fail	0 - 4.5	Fails to answer the prompt. Missing external research entirely. Poorly structured, lacking citations, or demonstrating fundamental misunderstandings of the topic.